

API Integration Best Practices

Developer Guide | Version 2.3 | June 2023

1. Authentication

Use API keys or OAuth. Store in env variables. Test keys: ns_test_*, Prod: ns_live_*. Rotate every 90 days.

2. Rate Limiting

Check X-RateLimit-Remaining. Exponential backoff on 429. Cache responses. Use webhooks over polling.

3. Error Handling

Check status codes. Log X-Request-ID. Retry 5xx with backoff. Don't retry 4xx without fixing.

4. Pagination

Cursor-based for large datasets. Max 1000 per page. Store cursors for resume.

5. Webhooks

Verify HMAC-SHA256 signatures. Respond 2xx in 30s. Process async. Implement idempotency.

6. Security

HTTPS only (TLS 1.2+). Validate SSL. Never log secrets. IP allowlisting for prod.